

A Cycle of Songs, Op.68

4. Tears, idle tears

Alfred Tennyson

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Andante moderato
Andante moderato (♩. = 46)

Piano

The piano introduction is in 6/8 time, marked *f* (forte). It features a melody in the right hand and a bass line in the left hand, both with a flowing, arpeggiated character. The melody starts on a half note G4, followed by quarter notes A4, B4, and C5, then a half note D5. The bass line starts on a half note G3, followed by quarter notes F3, E3, and D3, then a half note C3. The piece concludes with a final chord of G4-B4-D5-G3.

S
Tears, i-dle tears, I know not what they mean, Tears from the

A
Tears, i-dle tears, I know not what they mean, Tears from the

T
Tears, i-dle tears, I know not what they mean, Tears from the

B
Tears, i-dle tears, I know not what they mean, Tears from the

The vocal staves are arranged in a four-part setting. Each part begins with a measure of rest, followed by the lyrics. The Soprano (S) and Alto (A) parts are in treble clef, while the Tenor (T) and Bass (B) parts are in bass clef. The lyrics are: "Tears, i-dle tears, I know not what they mean, Tears from the". The music is marked *mf* (mezzo-forte) with an accent (>) on the first note of each line, and *p* (piano) on the second note of each line. The Soprano part ends with a half note G4, the Alto with a half note F#4, the Tenor with a half note E4, and the Bass with a half note D3.

The piano accompaniment for the vocal staves is in 6/8 time, marked *p* (piano). It features a melody in the right hand and a bass line in the left hand, both with a flowing, arpeggiated character. The melody starts on a half note G4, followed by quarter notes A4, B4, and C5, then a half note D5. The bass line starts on a half note G3, followed by quarter notes F3, E3, and D3, then a half note C3. The piece concludes with a final chord of G4-B4-D5-G3.

10

S
depth of some di - vine des - pair Rise in the heart, and

A
depth of some di - vine des - pair Rise in the heart, and

T
depth of some di - vine des - pair Rise in the heart, and

B
depth of some di - vine des - pair Rise in the heart, and

14

S
gath - er to the eyes, In look - ing on the hap - py Au-tumn

A
gath - er to the eyes, In look - ing on the hap - py Au-tumn

T
gath - er to the eyes, In look - ing on the hap - py Au-tumn

B
gath - er to the eyes, In look - ing on the hap - py Au-tumn

19

S *pp.*
fields, And think-ing of the days that are no more.

A *pp*
fields, And think-ing of the days that are no more.

T *pp*
fields, And think-ing of the days that are no more.

B *pp*
fields, And think-ing of the days that are no more.

26

S *f*
Fresh as the

A *f*
Fresh as the

T *f*
Fresh as the

B *f*
Fresh as the

30

S first beam glitt' - ring on a sail, That brings oufrinds up from the

A first beam glitt' - ring on a sail, That brings oufrinds up from the

T first beam glitt' - ring on a sail, That brings oufrinds up from the

B first beam glitt' - ring on a sail, That brings oufrinds up from the

35

S un - der-world, Sad as the last which red - dens o-ver

A un - der-world, Sad as the last which red - dens o-ver

T un - der-world, Sad as the last which red - dens o-ver

B un - der-world, Sad as the last which red - dens o-ver

40

S one That sinks with all we love be -

A one That sinks with all we love be -

T one That sinks with all we love be -

B one That sinks with all we love be -

dim.

44

S - low the verge; So sad, so

A - low the verge; So sad, so

T - low the verge; So sad, so

B - low the verge; So sad, so

pp

49

S fresh, the days that are no more.

A fresh, the days that are no more.

T fresh, the days that are are no more.

B fresh, the days that are no more.

54

p **Più mosso**

S Ah, sad and strange as

A Ah, sad and strange as

T Ah, sad and strange as

B Ah, sad and strange as

Più mosso (♩ = 72)

61

S in dark sum - mer dawns The ear-liest pipe of half - a - wak-en'd birds To

A in dark sum - mer dawns

T in dark sum - mer dawns The ear-liest pipe of half - a - wak-en'd birds To

B in dark sum - mer dawns

L.H. L.H.

70

S dy - ing ears, when un - to dy - ing eyes The case-ment slow - ly

A when un - to dy - ing eyes The case-ment slow - ly

T dy - ing ears, when un - to dy - ing eyes The case-ment slow - ly

B when un - to dy - ing eyes The case-ment slow - ly

col 2nd. _____

79

S grows a glimm'-ring square. So sad,

A grows a glimm'-ring square. So sad,

T grows a glimm'-ring square. So sad,

B grows a glimm'-ring square. So sad,

88 **Tempo I**

S so strange, _____ The days ___ that are ___ no more.

A so strange, _____ The days ___ that are ___ no more.

T so strange, _____ The days ___ that are ___ no more.

B so strange, _____ The days ___ that are ___ no more.

Tempo I

98 *mf*

S Dear as re-mem-ber'd

A *mf* Dear as re-mem-ber'd

T *mf* Dear as re-mem-ber'd

B *mf* Dear as re-mem-ber'd

102

S kis - ses af - ter death, _____ And sweet _____ as those by hope-less

A kis - ses af - ter death, _____ And sweet _____ as those by hope-less

T kis - ses af - ter death, _____ And sweet _____ as those by hope-less

B kis - ses af - ter death, _____ And sweet _____ as those by hope-less

106

S
fan - cy feign'd on lips that are for oth - ers; deep _____ as

A
fan - cy feign'd on lips that are for oth - ers; deep _____ as

T
fan - cy feign'd on lips that are for oth - ers; deep _____ as

B
fan - cy feign'd on lips that are for oth - ers; deep _____ as

110

S
love, Deep _____ as first love, and

A
love, Deep _____ as first love, and

T
love, Deep _____ as first love, and

B
love, Deep _____ as first love, and

113 *ff*

S wild, wild with all re - gret; O

A *ff* wild, wild with all re - gret; O

T *ff* wild, wild with all re - gret; O

B *ff* wild, wild with all re - gret; O

f

117 *ff*

S Death in life, O Death

A *ff* Death in life, O Death

T *ff* Death in life, O Death

B *ff* Death in life, O Death

dim.

122

S *p* The days _____ that

A *p* The days _____ that

T *p* _____ in life, _____ The days _____ that

B *p* _____ in life, _____ The days _____ that

127

S *pp* are no more. _____

A *pp* are no more. _____

T *pp* are no more. _____

B *pp* are no more. _____